

Jackson Barberi, RHP, Florida

2026 Stats: 3.13 ERA/37.1 IP/1.018 WHIP/55 K/17 BB/3.24 K:BB

6-4, 205

Metrics

FB: 97.3/21 IVB/11.1 HB/-4.44 VAA/5.4 ext/6.33 relH/33.7% zone/46 AA/51.3% usage/2540 rpm

SL: 85.3/-0.8 IVB/-7.2 HB/-8.14 VAA/31.4% zone/40.1 AA/43.2% usage/2640 rpm

CH: 91.3/4.6 IVB/17.3 HB/-6.96 VAA/37.8% zone/37.2 AA/5.6% usage/1750 rpm

Write-up

Barberi is a second year RHP out of Florida who was a highly touted recruit and has shown a great deal of promise in his two collegiate seasons. This year he emerged as the teams primary fire-man out of the pen, consistently coming in and shutting down the opposition with a high octane FB and wipeout SL combo. The build looks like a reliever with a fast arm and inconsistent command and he has yet to showcase an offspeed pitch that will get lefties out at the next level. It might not matter out of the pen though as the FB and SL are a dominant pairing with his ability to run it into the triple digits and could help a big league pen relatively quickly after the draft.

FB is the primary pitch in the arsenal, running into the triple digits with elite ride. Barberi rips through the baseball, generating 98th percentile spin rates that help create late life through the top of the zone while maintaining slight ASR. Don't be fooled by the lower zone rate, Barberi has shown ability to attack gloveside and up with the FB letting his slight ASR pull FB's back into the zone D/A to righties and almost front hip to lefties. He dominates from the belt up allowing a .143 on FBs in the upper half with a whopping 35.6% whiff rate. Arm side command is not quite there yet as FBs tend to fall off the plate when armside. He is not a big extender which is odd considering the build and shape profile but the FB still carries through the zone to average VAA helping the exceptional ride play up. This will be one of the best pure FB's in the draft, especially if he can find the zone at a slightly higher rate. 60/70 pitch

If the FB is the bread, the SL is the butter for Barberi and is a plus pitch with two plane movement with late, sharp depth. The pitch generated a 38.3% whiff rate on the year and he showed the ability to move the slider around. To righties he works away throwing off the plate down for whiffs and as a 2K killer. To lefties, he was able to both back door and back foot. The high spin helps create late depth leading to an incredibly steep -8.14 VAA which presents an interesting comp to Dodger reliever Edgardo Henriquez's slider which is running a 37.8% whiff rate in 2026 as of June 19th. The pitch is already a plus offering and projects comfortably as a professional out pitch, though most of the remaining development will likely come through improved command rather than shape refinement.

60/60 pitch

The CH is the low hanging fruit in the profile with it only being used 5.6% of the time and 11.4% to lefties. It garnered solid results with a .250 avg and 0 XBH against with a 35% whiff rate. The shape profile is there but he tends to throw it low and in to lefties instead of low and away. He got away with it because of its elite velo and big vertical separation off the FB but at the next level, throwing front hip changeups will eventually lead to XBH with lefties dropping the barrel onto the bat. If Barberi uses it more in 27 with better feel for locating arm-side, the pitch could end up as a lefty weapon that could push him into a more consistent multi-innings role.

35/45 pitch